

Travel Management System (Corporate Travel Planning)

Problem Statement

Organizations face major inefficiencies in managing employee travel requests, approvals, bookings, reimbursements, and compliance tracking. Currently, travel requests are handled via emails, spreadsheets, or disconnected internal tools, leading to:

- Lack of centralized visibility on travel requests and approvals
- Delays in approval workflows due to manual coordination
- No standardized travel policies enforcement
- Difficulty in tracking travel expenses and reimbursements
- Inconsistent record keeping for audits and reporting
- Poor employee experience due to unclear status tracking

There is a need for a **centralized, rule-driven Travel Management System** that automates the entire lifecycle from request creation to expense closure.

Scope

The system should:

- Allow employees to create travel requests
- Implement multi-level approval workflows
- Track itineraries and travel schedules
- Manage expense submissions and reimbursements
- Maintain complete audit logs

No external booking APIs or integrations should be considered.

Core Features

1. Travel Request Creation

- Employee submits request with:
 - Destination

- Travel dates
 - Purpose
 - Estimated budget
- Draft and submit functionality

2. Approval Workflow

- Configurable multi-level approval:
 - Manager approval
 - Finance approval
- Auto-routing based on department hierarchy
- Approval/rejection with comments

3. Policy Enforcement

- Predefined travel policies:
 - Budget limits
 - Allowed travel classes
- System flags violations

4. Itinerary Management

- Manual entry of:
 - Travel segments
 - Stay details
- Timeline visualization

5. Expense Management

- Add expense entries:
 - Category (food, stay, transport)
 - Amount
- Upload proof (file storage simulation)
- Reimbursement tracking

6. Reporting

- Travel cost reports
 - Employee travel history
 - Department-wise spend
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Constraints

- No external booking or payment systems
 - All data stored internally
 - Simulated file storage only
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Expected SDLC Outcomes

- Workflow engine design
- Role-based access control
- Transactional data modeling
- Approval state machine implementation